

The New Nature Brings Perfected Praise

Open to three places: Matthew 21, Hebrews 2, and Psalm 8. I believe the course will go from Matthew to Psalm 8, and then from Psalm 8 to Hebrews 2, fluctuating back and forth between those two.

Hallelujah.

How many are enjoying the presence of a believer? Should I say the anointing of a believer? Why am I enjoying that anointing?

Hallelujah. Thank You, Jesus.

This part is on worship, giving Him the glory, and a little positional truth about worship as we take another step down this born-again trail.

Before we do, let us pass in review a little where we left off, if possible. It is these reviews I get lost in and never come back from.

I have been enjoying the corporate worship so much lately. Waves and waves of glory just pass over my spirit. I can hardly stand it. Like I have told you, I cannot tell sometimes whether you are having church with me or not. Not that you are not having church; I just cannot tell sometimes whether you are.

It used to be I could tell, because I would have church when you had it, and He would come, and then He would go home and we would go home. But since He put the worship limb on, He pretty much just stays. He is on me so strong at times that I cannot tell where it stops and begins. I will just be having church like crazy by myself, then look up and people are looking at me, and I am thinking, "I cannot tell anymore. It is okay. Just let me go on with it. I am having a good time."

In the understanding of this worship limb, connected now with the glory limb, connected now with grace and the love of God, I think I understand something. When He began to put this last limb on, which I have been talking about for a good three or four months, the glory limb, I now know that His putting the worship limb on and taking me in to teach me about worship had everything to do with unveiling God's heart, or His love, to me, and knowing that one day I would understand it enough to teach on it.

As worship has begun to open God's love up to me, I can understand how dangerous worship is to the devil. It is a very, very dangerous thing to him. I do not yet fully understand how dangerous, but I am beginning to get glimpses of it.

As you know, in Lucifer's creation, until that time, God called him the sum total. Anything God had created before that was summed up in him, particularly in his beauty. His beauty, as I understand, was absolutely something to behold.

I think his beauty, as he moved through creation, represented God. Everything God was, as far as beauty is concerned, could be seen in him, and it opened creation up to worship. You would just want to worship God, or the Father. He opened creation up to worship.

Sometime in the eons of times past, and only God can say when, something happened. We do not know how old Lucifer is, the one who earned the title Satan. We just know that somewhere back in the history of time, something happened. He became exalted in his heart and wanted to be like the Most High. He wanted to sit on the mount of the congregation on the sides of the north. He ascended to some mount that represented being over people and nations, and he wanted to sit there in the place of God.

If he was in charge of opening creation to worship and understanding, then somewhere along the line he began to receive it for himself and became exalted in his own heart.

For us to understand how that can even happen, a creation that was the sum total of what had existed up to that point, in all his beauty, we need to understand this: one of the attributes God created in His creation is will. We have a will in our creation.

Something happened. I suspect it was along the line of the main reason he wanted to be like the Most High: to receive the worship of creation. I can tell you now, it must have given him a high he could get no other way. I know what happens to men when they begin to receive the glory. I know what happens to men when they receive the exaltation.

That is why I will reinforce this one more time: some things belong to God. All the glory, all the honor, all the praise, all of it belongs to Him.

The world has borrowed the terminology of grace. It borrowed it from the expanding knowledge of the Bible. The world uses it: "They have a lot of grace in that area," meaning they have strength in that area.

Really, grace was a word coined by God in every language to describe all that you and I have as a free gift. Be very careful to understand that without the freedom of that gifting, without everything being so available and so free, we would have nothing.

But understand also that because it is so free and such a gift, when you begin to think inside that somehow there is something special about you, something special that caused God to treat you the way He treats you, something special that made Him give you more than someone else, trust you with more than someone else, gift you with more than someone else, those little seed thoughts are the beginnings of your fall.

There is no respecter of persons. You must understand this. It is impossible for Him to love one of you more than He loves another. It is impossible for Him to give one of you more, as far as He and who He is and what is available to you. There are differences in callings, but it is impossible for Him to bestow on one of you more than another because of a decision of His own person that He likes you separately or a little more.

Hello, grace.

Glory be to God.

So in your worship, remember that some things belong to Him. Your faith will increase when you begin to realize this.

In that seeking time, when He peeled back the onion skin of the Father's heart and I got to see a little through a thin layer, I walked away from there. When people wanted to come up and thank me for different reasons, saying, "The teaching you gave me has changed my whole life," I wanted to put my running shoes on.

That anointing was fresh on me, fresh with His love, the glory limb, and His grace connected with it. I wanted to run. I felt like a thief, like a robber trying to take something from God that belonged to Him and receive it to myself. I wanted to run like a scalded dog.

I knew what they were doing. They were appreciating me, loving me, and thanking me for faithfulness and those kinds of things. Still, in the freshness of that, I wanted to run. I did not want to receive any of it. It was so precious, and His grace was so strong.

Hallelujah.

I am finding some kind of balance in there somewhere. What I am saying is that self-exaltation, taking little pieces of the stead of Christ and little pieces of His glory to yourself, is as addictive as crank. It is like a drug. When you get on it, it is hard to get off.

We do not know how many millions of years it took, but Satan finally said, "I will be like the Most High." He began to divert worship.

The mountain he took Jesus up on in temptation was a high mountain from which he could show Him the kingdoms of the world and all the glory of them. He said, "Just fall down and worship me, and all of it will be Yours."

Is that not something? When he finished tempting Jesus in the natural realm, "Turn the stones to bread," then in the emotional realms of the soul, badgering and pushing Him to the limit, the final temptation he went for was spirit. He wanted Him to get down and worship him.

This worship-receiving, crazed maniac is trying to get all the false religions of the world to do that. He wants them to bow down. He is crazy, perverted, self-exalted, and will even take secondhand worship. He just wants to be worshiped and revered as God.

He will put human beings through all kinds of things: grinding human skulls, grinding bones, taking organs, making potions. Why? Points of contact. The same devils witchcraft uses to send those things after you. Human sacrifice is an ultimate power for witches, and they will take it that far. Then they have powers at their disposal, big devils that will go on assignment against you because those people bid them to do so.

But really, they are no different from any other devil. They will single you out to destroy you because you are climbing up in God. All those crazy things the devil puts people through, perverted worship, potions, sacrifices, are just points of contact. They mean nothing.

People ask, "Are you afraid of this?"

No. You could grind human skulls, make a hut out of bones, curse me, and throw witch powder. It is just a bunch of people directing the devil at me. I already know that devil. Send all of them you want. It does not make any difference to me. They come after me anyway. You do not have to wave some stupid stick with feathers on it. That does not make any difference to me. They are after me anyway.

The devil is crazy. He wants worship.

The way we look at it, we think Satan's rise, rebellion, and fall happened almost in the time span of human creation. Jesus said He saw Satan fall as lightning from heaven before Adam, so he had already fallen when the Garden of Eden took place.

I do not know how long God dealt with him. I do not know how long God dealt with his heart. I do not think God's standard would be different. I do not know how many times or how much mercy God extended. All I know is that Satan was already cast out of heaven, yet he was free to move in our creation when he approached Adam.

People make up theology and speculate that God used him to try our creation, or used him for this or that. But what I do know is that in the next level of incarceration, he will not be free to wander anywhere. He will be in the lake of fire with the false prophet. He will not approach any more creation. God is incarcerating him in stages.

I do not believe God left him loose merely to tempt us. I do not think so.

I am talking about the mercy of God and the love He has for you and me. However long it took for Satan to finish his fall, I do not know. But in eternity past, God did not immediately do what I would have done. If it had been me, I would have said, "That is it. You messed up. You rebelled against Me." I would have incarcerated him and thrown him into hell so he could never fool with anybody or anything again.

Yet he was on the loose. To me, there would not have been any other reason except that God was trying. He had to have been trying.

Worship means that much to the devil. Yes, he was the sum total of beauty in creation. God put it in him. He opened creation up to worship. He knew what worship meant to God, and he wanted it. He wanted to be lifted up.

If Satan was over worship and knew what it meant to God, then know this: God loves you. What we call worship is you returning that love to God on a personal level and a corporate level. That is what He calls worship: you loving Him.

The more time you spend in His presence talking to Him, adoring and loving Him, the more you see that there was something about worship Satan wanted, and he fell. He watched God in His place in the universe as Creator. He watched Him. He saw how much God enjoyed creation returning that love and fellowship, and he wanted it for himself.

God enjoys us, His creation, whom He made for fellowship. Again, we equate worship with the God factor, and that is true. But worship is you returning what He has already given to you.

He loves you.

This is the part I am having trouble with. He just uncovered the tiniest bit of His love, and I am having trouble. Maybe I need to learn Greek. The New Testament seems to be written in a more expressive language, with words and tenses and meanings. In English, we often have to say a word and then use half the language to describe what we mean by it.

I am having lots of trouble interpreting what has gone off in me. It is translating into more tears than I have ever cried in my life. Good tears. They are good tears.

I am seeing also that love flows as an anointing. What took me years in praying in tongues can come in an anointing and begin to break people down, where they love Him more than anything in the world. I love anointings like that.

I am having a little trouble trying to translate the love He has for us.

The devil has indicted God and charged Him falsely with everything under the sun for our suffering: unfaithfulness, lack, need, disease, and pain. He has framed God for every bit of it. In that framing process, religion has coined phrases the devil uses, like, "God can, but He will not."

That is about as far from God's love and who He really is as you can get.

"He can, but He will not."

Then we sit there and evaluate the situation we are going through, lack, pain, disease, a broken relationship, a destroyed marriage, trying to handle all the emotions and crisis of it. The devil stands there framing God and screaming that at us while God is trying to tell us He loves us. Then we wonder why He cannot get through.

You only have one answer first: the Holy Ghost has been trying to interpret the Word for two thousand years. He finally reveals a road in.

Thank God.

If you want to understand the mystery of God and the mystery of His love in Jesus Christ, take the road He created into the heart of God when He said He would build you up on your most holy faith and edify you through praying in tongues. Take it.

Right now, I am caught between two things: coming out of the greatest framing job the devil ever did against God, and trying to translate His heart as I walk into it one step at a time.

I do know this: His love comes down to me, and then I get to turn around and send back how it has affected my heart in worship. My expression back to Him as His creation is worship.

I can remember how difficult the hours were at first. God, in respect to where I was walking, had to retreat to the other side of the bulk of my flesh and camp there. He would come over once in a while, bless me real good, give me a drink of living water, bless me, pet on me a while, and then retreat back to the other side of the flesh so I would be aware of where I was really walking.

I would worship through dry spells, and He would come and bless, bless, bless. Glory, glory, here is a drink of living water. Then He would go back, and I would be isolated again where I really was. I kept worshipping and worshipping until every framing of the devil, every icon he created, everything that was not true, everything people had said about my Father that was not true, was faced.

I did not care what I felt like. I did not care what anybody said. I did not care about anything except what He told me to do. Finally I broke through enough where He could stay with me longer and longer, until my worship seemed to come out as a sweet-smelling presence, a savor in His presence, because He is staying longer all the time.

Hallelujah.

Do I have any flesh left? Ask me. Do not ask anybody around me; ask me. Of course. But I am also receiving the tools to deliver myself from those extra levels of flesh that seem to be acceptable in the Christian community.

Amen.

Is He not glorious?

Satan watched God receive worship and saw the creatures around the throne. There is something about God; He is so full of love. How could His creation not have the essence and substance of what He is? The animal kingdom was not created to be murderous the way you see it now. When regeneration begins, the lion will go back to grazing, and the child will play with the poisonous asp, the snake that could kill him in seconds.

Something happened in creation. Those animals do not have a spirit, so something happened on the soul level. Animals are murderers now; they kill each other for food. When the devil gets his way in cultures, those cultures gravitate toward human sacrifice and cannibalism. When he isolates people, possession becomes rampant, and it ends in human sacrifice and cannibalism.

The devil reduces creatures created in God's presence to something that crawls below dirt level. Do you not think he rejoices in his hatred for God, to see something once in the image of God crawling around in the dirt eating people's brains? It makes me sick to think about serving him even in an outburst of anger, nothing to do with him except a series of orders here and there.

All God's creation, created after Him, has to have that element of love, for He is love. He does not merely have love; He is love. It had to be in His creation.

If you wanted a visual effect of the nearest thing to heaven, I think it would be beautiful arrays of flowers in gardens, such as in Florida. You walk down those paths, and I think that is about as close to heaven as you can get. All that beauty He wove into a lily, and Solomon in all that he could muster in his glory was not as beautiful as something God clothed like that.

His heart and His love went into creation. When creation gives it back, it comes back in the form of fellowship. That is what God craves and wants as a Father: His love for me returned in fellowship.

Hallelujah.

Do you love Him?

There is unexplored territory in God waiting for you if you want it. My prayer for you is that you do not appease yourself by going on and playing religion.

Thank God for programs, but ask the elder brother of the prodigal son: programs will not replace your fellowship with God.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Programs are supposed to be a function of government. They are there to organize the great expanding move of God, not to replace it or to try to cause it. If you have not been trained by God first and the program second, then you are going to be a little programmed, programming other people later on.

Let us explore a couple of these verses. Remember, we are in the Bible right now.

Hallelujah.

Let me see if I can finish a complete thought here.

Hang on closely, because there are a lot of meditators and lovers of the Word here. If I can get enough over to you for you to take it on in yourself, this is one of those things that holds freedom from this temporary world in it. It is one of those truths that stills your enemies, plural. You have a lot of enemies: poverty, disease, and others. If I can get enough over to you for you to take it inside and understand it, this truth will still many of your enemies for you.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Let us begin where Jesus quoted Psalm 8. Put your finger over there, and let us pick on Matthew 21 for a minute.

Matthew 21:13 says:

My house shall be called the house of prayer; but ye have made it a den of thieves.

They had made it a place where people came and preyed on other people's religious hunger to make money. This is the same time Jesus took a whip and cleansed the temple from the money changers. A Roman coin would not be accepted as a clean offering, so the money changers were there, and I am sure for a little interest they would change your Roman coin to Jewish. Those who sold doves for sacrifice were there too. I am sure the convenience of having them right in the temple came with a higher-quality price.

"After all, these are specially bred doves for sacrifice. They have never touched anything unclean. These will get the job done. That is why we charge a dollar or two more."

Jesus called them thieves. He was highly unhappy with them. To merchandise on somebody's hunger for God does not make Him very happy.

Hallelujah.

Then:

And the blind and the lame came to Him in the temple; and He healed them.

I like how simply it says that. The blind and the lame came to Him in the temple, and He healed them.

Then:

And when the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things that He did, and the children crying in the temple, and saying, Hosanna to the son of David; they were sore displeased,

And said unto Him, Hearest Thou what these say?

And Jesus saith unto them, Yea; have ye never read, Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings Thou hast perfected praise?

In verse 15, the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things, the miracles, the healing, the blind and the lame. To me this would have been the strangest sight. Here they were bringing the lame to Him, and the crowds were getting to watch men who could not walk, twisted up, untwist and get up. People who were probably born blind, who had never seen, were seeing. The crowd would get excited.

But the Pharisees and temple priests were there, and the ones who expressed the excitement were the children. Whether the adults were afraid to or not, the children were the ones crying out:

Hosanna to the son of David.

"Blessed is the King. Hosanna to the Son of David, He that cometh in the name of the Lord."

The children were crying out and worshiping Him.

The leaders said, "Can You not hear what these children are saying?"

Jesus answered, "Have you never read?" Then He quoted directly from Psalm 8 for what these children were doing.

I went immediately over to Psalm 8. I had to understand why those children were crying like that.

The adults were probably afraid they would be put out of the temple. After all, Jesus would go on His way, and where would that leave them? But the children cried out.

When Jesus talked about the kingdom, what did He compare it to? When they asked who was greatest in the kingdom, He took a little child and set him in the midst of them. When they tried to forbid the children from coming to Him so He could touch them, He said, "Let them come to Me."

He would relate the kingdom to the state of innocence a child is born in. Here were all these fearful adults, and out of the innocence of a child came, "Hosanna," in worship of Him.

Jesus said, "Have you not read?" and quoted Psalm 8. But what got me is that He quoted the verse differently than Psalm 8 words it. This is Jesus quoting it, so you know He authored it back there in Psalms. In Matthew He said:

Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings Thou hast perfected praise.

Now look at Psalm 8:

O LORD our Lord, how excellent is Thy name in all the earth! who hast set Thy glory above the heavens.

Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings hast Thou ordained strength because of Thine enemies, that Thou mightest still the enemy and the avenger.

The strength He ordained because of His enemies, in a perfected state, stills your enemies.

This whole chapter is talking about Jesus being made lower than the angels for the purpose of suffering death. Verse 3 says:

When I consider Thy heavens, the work of Thy fingers, the moon and the stars, which Thou hast ordained;

What is man, that Thou art mindful of him? and the son of man, that Thou visitest him?

Who is man? What kind of creation is this, God, that You have a mind full of them? When I look at the heavens, the work of Your fingers, the moon and the vastness of it all, who are we? What is man that You are mindful of him? And who is this Son of Man that You visited him with? Really, He visited us with Him.

Then:

For Thou hast made Him a little lower than the angels, and hast crowned Him with glory and honour.

I do not have to break this verse and meditate until my meditator falls out on the ground, because Paul already broke it for me in Hebrews 2.

Go to Hebrews 2. Let us start with verse 6. Thank you, apostle Paul, for quoting the old in the new:

But one in a certain place testified, saying, What is man, that Thou art mindful of him? or the son of man, that Thou visitest him?

Thou madest Him a little lower than the angels; Thou crownedst Him with glory and honour, and didst set Him over the works of Thy hands.

Then Paul explains the quote:

Thou hast put all things in subjection under His feet.

For in that He put all in subjection under Him, He left nothing that is not put under Him. But now we do not yet see all things put under Him. What do we see? We see a work that is not finished yet, but that is all right, because we see Jesus:

But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, crowned with glory and honour.

He was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, and then He was crowned with glory and honor.

Thank you, apostle Paul, for breaking Psalm 8. For that reason, I can break the rest of it.

Jump down to verse 14:

Forasmuch then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood, He also Himself likewise took part of the same; that through death He might destroy him that had the power of death, that is, the devil;

And deliver them who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.

In Psalm 8, when it says, "Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings Thou hast ordained strength because of Thine enemies," the strength Jesus ordained was this: He was made a little lower than the angels, He suffered death, and He destroyed the devil's hold over us.

When we were born again, we became the newborn babes and sucklings. The children in the temple were a type and shadow of what you and I would become when we were born again. In their innocence, when they lifted their hands and cried, "Hosanna, Hosanna to the King who comes in the name of the Lord," they foreshadowed us.

The enemy is stilled in that ordained strength He gave us in the new nature. When that ordained strength is perfected, like it was in the temple, we begin to worship and praise Him out of that new nature.

Old Testament saints could not perfect praise because they were not born again babes and sucklings. But you and I have been born again. We have received the ordained strength of the new nature, which stills the enemy and can go on into perfected praise, because we can give God what He seeks: worship out of our new nature.

Those children were a type. Out of their innocence in the temple, how could they know the religious games? How could they know the adults were afraid? How could they know there was anything wrong? They just cried, "Hosanna," and worshiped Him.

Jesus said, "Have you not read? Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings..." Now He is talking about me. He has ordained strength because of my enemies.

Oh, He stills the enemy.

Hallelujah.

He gave me power over all the power of the enemy. He has ordained strength because of my enemies, the avenger.

When I start worshiping God, yes sir, that is what He told the Samaritan woman:

The hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth: for the Father seeketh such to worship Him.

God is a Spirit: and they that worship Him must worship Him in spirit and in truth.

Again, God is not hopping from one worship team to another, looking for worshipers. It means He waited out the dispensations, seeking and waiting for the day when the first men would appear on this earth with new natures.

The Old Testament saints could not worship Him out of spirit because they were not born again yet. But we can.

Psalm 8 was prophesying of us:

Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings hast Thou ordained strength because of Thine enemies.

Jesus was made a little lower than the angels to suffer my death and destroy the power of the devil. That is the ordained strength He has given to you and me. Now we can perfect praise because God is a Spirit and He seeks such to worship Him in spirit and in truth.

He has ordained strength, and that strength is perfected out of the mouth of His newborn babes and sucklings when they worship Jesus, when they worship Him and watch Him heal the blind and the lame, and worship Him as He heals more.

Do you want Him to come into the crowd and heal the lame and blind? Then out of the mouth of babes and sucklings, the enemy is stilled. Worship Him. Worship Him.

We are talking about all your enemies: disease, poverty, and everything else. Take that strength He ordained and let it be perfected in your life. The children were the shadow. You are the real babe. You are the real suckling. That is where praise begins its journey to perfection, because you have been restored to fellowship with the heart of the Father.

You now have capacity for perfected praise.